From an old Kindle to a weather clock

This project turns an old Kindle into a clock and weather display. It runs on the Kindle itself. It needs no server and no extra hardware.

How it was built

Each feature went through the same five steps:

1. Describe the feature.
2. Write the code.
3. Preview the screen on a PC.
4. Test it on the real Kindle.
5. Fix the bugs that photos and logs showed.

This loop repeated many times. Each round produced a new version.

The seven versions

- v1: big clock and today's weather.
- v2: 5-day forecast.
- v3: touch buttons (light, flip, view, rotate, exit).
- v4: landscape mode.
- v5: city picker. Only major Romanian cities are listed.
- v6: English/Romanian button, 12h/24h clock, °C/°F.
- v7: final version 3.0, with a simpler light menu and larger buttons.

Who did what

The design and ideas are mine. The code was written by Claude, Anthropic's AI assistant, from my requests.

Thank you

This project stands on the work of others:

- The idea came from the open-source rekindle project by Chaozhuang22: github.com/Chaozhuang22/rekindle
- I learned the jailbreak from the Oak Reef guide: oakreef.ie/bog/kindle-jailbreaking
- The Kindle community built the tools: KUAL, MobileRead (mobileread.com) and KindleModding (kindlemodding.org).
- FBInk by NiLuJe draws on the screen: github.com/NiLuJe/FBInk
- Open-Meteo provides the weather data: open-meteo.com

Thank you to everyone who built and shared these tools for free.

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How the project was built, step by step. Every step was tested before the next one started.

1. **Describe** — Ask for a feature
2. **Build** — Write the code
3. **Preview** — Draw the screen on a PC
4. **Test** — Try it on the real Kindle
5. **Fix** — Photos and logs show bugs

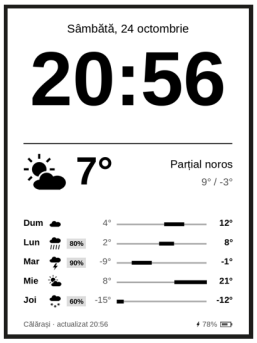
The loop repeated many times. Each round produced a new version.

v1 Clock and weather



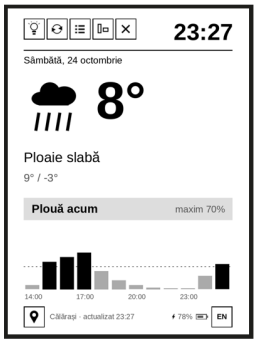
First idea: reuse an old, unused Kindle. A big clock plus today's weather from the internet.

v2 5-day forecast



Added a daily forecast with highs, lows and rain chance. Two layouts to choose from.

v3 Touch buttons



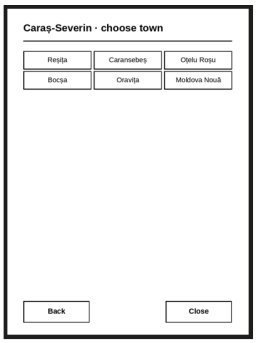
Buttons for light, flip, view, portrait/landscape and exit. A clock in the corner.

v4 Landscape mode



The screen can turn sideways, so it fits on a desk stand.

v5 City picker



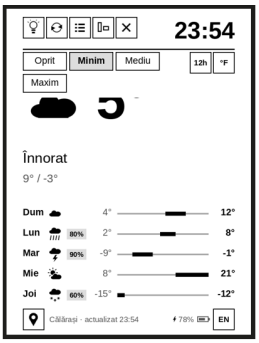
Choose a county (only the major cities of Romania are listed), then a town. Favorites on top.

v6 Language and units



English / Romanian button. 12h / 24h clock and °C / °F switches.

v7 Final version 3.0



Simpler light menu with larger buttons, so it is easy to hit on a touch screen.

What it runs on

- Kindle Paperwhite 1 (2012)
- Jailbroken, no extra hardware
- Runs on the Kindle itself
- Weather data: Open-Meteo (free)
- Menu: KUAL, "Clock and weather"
- Works over Wi-Fi only
- Screens here are PC previews

Legend and thank-you

Starting point

The open-source "rekindle" project by Chaozhuang22 gave me the idea: github.com/Chaozhuang22/rekindle

Design and ideas

The project owner. Code: written by Claude, Anthropic's AI assistant, from those requests.

Jailbreak (done by hand from a Windows laptop)

Learned from the Oak Reef guide: oakreef.ie/bog/kindle-jailbreaking. Steps: downgrade to 5.4.4, K5 jailbreak, back to 5.6.1.1.

Menu and tools by the Kindle community: KUAL, MobileRead forums (mobileread.com), KindleModding (kindlemodding.org).

Libraries used on the Kindle

FBInk by NiLuJe (github.com/NiLuJe/FBInk) draws on the screen. Weather data: Open-Meteo (open-meteo.com).

Thank you to everyone who built and shared these tools for free.